

Flutter Routing

1. What is Routing?

You already know how to navigate using `Navigator.push()` and `Navigator.pop()`. Routing is simply a better way to organise that navigation when your app grows.

The Problem With Inline Navigation

Every time you navigate to a new screen, you write this:

```
Navigator.push(
  context,
  MaterialPageRoute(builder: (context) => DetailScreen()),
);
```

This works fine for 2–3 screens. But in a larger app this code gets scattered everywhere. If you rename `DetailScreen`, you have to find and update every single call across your entire project.

Named routes solve this. You register all your screens in one place and navigate using a simple string.

2. Named Routes

Setting Up Named Routes

Everything is declared once inside `MaterialApp`:

```
MaterialApp(
  initialRoute: '/',          // first screen shown when app launches
  routes: {
    '/': (context) => HomeScreen(),
    '/detail': (context) => DetailScreen(),
    '/profile': (context) => ProfileScreen(),
  },
);
```

Then navigating from anywhere in your app becomes:

```
Navigator.pushNamed(context, '/detail');
```

No `MaterialPageRoute`, no widget reference, just a string. Going back is still the same `Navigator.pop(context)`.

Passing Data Between Screens

You often need to send data forward, a user ID, a product name, or anything else. You pass it as arguments:

Sending side

```
Navigator.pushNamed(
  context,
  '/detail',
  arguments: 'Hello from Home!',
);
```

Receiving side

```
class DetailScreen extends StatelessWidget {  
  @override  
  Widget build(BuildContext context) {  
    // extract the argument passed from the previous screen  
    final String message =  
      ModalRoute.of(context)!.settings.arguments as String;  
  
    return Scaffold(  
      appBar: AppBar(title: Text('Detail')),  
      body: Center(child: Text(message)),  
    );  
  }  
}
```

Note: You can pass any type — a String, an int, or a custom object like a User class.